

MARKETING SWEET · SALES PITCH PLAYBOOK

Google is a Librarian. Websites are Books. Here's how to pitch it.

Six cards. The metaphor, the four categories, the activity table, the product map, the DA analogy, and a daily reference. That's the pitch.

WHAT'S INSIDE

- 01 The librarian pitch**
The 60-second metaphor that resets the whole conversation.
- 02 The 4 categories of SEO**
On-page · Off-page · Technical · Local. Memorise these.
- 03 What each category actually is**
Answer the question: "but what do you actually do?"
- 04 Product → category map**
Plot every product against one of the four boxes.
- 05 Domain Authority = credibility**
Why DA is the author's reputation, not a vanity score.
- 06 Daily reference card**
Print and pin. Read every morning before the CRM.

The librarian pitch.

Use this metaphor in the first three minutes. It reframes everything that follows.

GOOGLE

The Librarian.

Has every book in the world.
Decides which ones get put on the shelf where the customer looks.

YOUR WEBSITE

A Book.

One of millions. Title, author, table of contents, references. Either useful — or invisible.

OUR JOB

Get your book shelved at eye-level.

That's the whole game. Everything else is a tactic underneath it.

OPENING SCRIPT — SAY THIS OUT LOUD

“Think of Google as a librarian. There are millions of websites — millions of books on the shelf. When someone searches for what you sell, the librarian decides which books to put at eye-level and which to leave in the back room. SEO is the work we do to convince the librarian that your book belongs at eye-level. We do that across four categories: what your book says, what other authors say about you, whether your book actually opens cleanly, and whether you're the local expert on the topic. Make sense?”

WHY THIS LANDS

Customers don't know what SEO is. They know what a library is. The metaphor gives them a mental model, makes the four categories obvious, and positions us as the people who talk to the librarian on their behalf.

The four categories.

Memorise these. Every product we sell sits in one of these four boxes.

01**ON-PAGE****What's inside the book.**

Words, headings, structure, internal links. The content the librarian actually reads.

IF THEY ASK "what is that?"
It's the content of the book.

02**OFF-PAGE****What others say about you.**

Backlinks, citations, mentions. Reputation built on other people's websites pointing to yours.

IF THEY ASK "what is that?"
It's the references other books make to yours.

03**TECHNICAL****Whether the book opens.**

Speed, mobile, indexing, schema, crawl health. Plumbing the librarian uses to read the book at all.

IF THEY ASK "what is that?"
It's the binding, the print, the spine.

04**LOCAL****Whether you're the local expert.**

Google Business Profile, reviews, map listings, NAP consistency. The librarian's local section.

IF THEY ASK "what is that?"
It's the local-authors section.

RULE OF THUMB

If a rep can't name all four categories without thinking — they're not ready to quote SEO.

What each category actually is.

Use this to answer “what do you actually do?” without saying “SEO stuff.”

CATEGORY	WHAT WE DO	WHAT THEY SEE	WHY IT MATTERS
ON-PAGE	Rewrite page titles, headings, body copy, internal links. Add schema markup. Build topic clusters.	Their pages read like they belong to someone who knows the topic.	<i>The librarian reads the book before recommending it.</i>
OFF-PAGE	Earn backlinks from relevant, high-authority sites. Outreach, digital PR, content placements.	Other websites — ideally well-known ones — start mentioning theirs.	<i>Authors with more references get shelved at eye-level.</i>
TECHNICAL	Fix speed, mobile usability, crawl errors, broken links, sitemaps, schema, indexing issues.	The site loads fast, works on mobile, doesn't break.	<i>If the librarian can't open the book, none of the content matters.</i>
LOCAL	Optimise Google Business Profile, build reviews, fix NAP consistency, add local landing pages.	They appear in the map pack when someone searches “near me.”	<i>60% of local searches happen on the map. Win the map or be invisible.</i>

Product → category map.

Every product, plotted. Use this to answer “what am I actually getting?”

PRODUCT	PRIMARY CATEGORY	ALSO TOUCHES	WHAT TO SAY
SEO content packages	On-page	Local (location pages)	<i>“We rewrite your book.”</i>
Backlink campaigns	Off-page	On-page (anchor strategy)	<i>“We get other authors to cite you.”</i>
Site audits & fixes	Technical	On-page (structure)	<i>“We make sure the book opens cleanly.”</i>
Google Business setup	Local	Off-page (citations)	<i>“We get you on the local shelf.”</i>
Review-generation tools	Local	Off-page (reputation)	<i>“We feed the librarian social proof.”</i>
Monthly SEO retainers	All four	Reporting + strategy	<i>“We work all four every month.”</i>

THE TEST

Before you quote, you should be able to point to a row on this map and say which category you're solving for. If you can't, the customer can't either — and the deal will stall on price.

Domain Authority = author credibility.

DA is not a vanity score. It's the librarian's read on how much weight your book carries.

THE DA LADDER

80–100

Wikipedia. The textbook everyone cites.

60–79

Established expert. Nationally referenced.

40–59

Known voice. Cited within the industry.

20–39

Emerging. Some references, growing.

0–19

Just published. Nobody's heard of you yet.

SAY IT THIS WAY

"If two authors wrote a book on the same topic, the librarian recommends the one with the better reputation. Domain Authority is that reputation — measured. The higher your DA, the more weight your pages carry, and the easier every other piece of SEO becomes."

Use this when the customer asks: "why can't I just rank?"

THREE RULES FOR USING DA IN A PITCH

1. Show the customer's DA and three competitors' DAs. Numbers > opinions.
2. Never promise to "raise DA by X." Promise the work that does it.
3. Frame backlink work as "getting other authors to cite your book."

The rep's daily reference card.

Print this. Pin it. Read it every morning before you open the CRM.

DO · THE PITCH HABITS

- Open with the librarian metaphor — every call.
- Name all four categories: on-page, off-page, technical, local.
- Point to the category each product solves for.
- Use the DA-as-author-reputation analogy.
- Speak in books, authors, shelves — not jargon.
- Diagnose before you quote.
- Hold the price. The work justifies it.

DON'T · THE PITCH KILLERS

- Don't explain SEO from scratch — open with the metaphor.
- Don't use keywords, SERPs, algorithms, indexation.
- Don't quote a product without naming the category.
- Don't promise “DA increases.” Promise the work.
- Don't dive into category 1 if the gap is in category 3.
- Don't apologise for the price.
- Don't forget local. It's half the deals.

THE ONE-LINER TO HOLD IN YOUR HEAD

Google is a librarian. Websites are books. Our job is to make sure the librarian shelves your book at eye-level.

If you can say that out loud, you can sell SEO.